

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Subtle Vajra, Unobstructed'

Vajrasūkṣmāpratihata-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 753 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་མཁའ་པོ་ཐོག་པ་མཛད་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 753 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Vajrasūkṣmāpratihata-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the dhāraṇī called "The Subtle Vajra, Unobstructed." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a short but potent ritual-scriptural work in which the Blessed One enters a samādhi of the Vajra Family, prompting Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, to appear and set the scene for the teaching of the dhāraṇī. The text was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla together with the great editor-translator the monk Yeshé Dé, and was subsequently revised in accordance with the new standardized vocabulary and definitively established.

It is complete.

This was translated by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, revised according to the new standardized vocabulary, and definitively established.

In the Indian language: Vajrasūkṣmāpratihata-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: the dhāraṇī called "The Subtle Vajra, Unobstructed."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Homage to all the wrathful ones of the Sugata.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One entered into meditative absorption in the samādhi of the Vajra Family. Through the power of the buddhas, Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, displayed a radiant, blazing face bearing the syllable Hūṃ, and took his seat before the Blessed One. At that moment, from the emanation of the Blessed One's mind there arose a brahmin youth, who spoke these words to the Lord of Secrets:

"Lord of Secrets, Lord of Vidyās, Lord of Dhāraṇīs — please recite the secret mantras, the vidyā mantras, and the dhāraṇī mantras that powerfully crush and overwhelm, with fierce and overpowering subjugation, the lesser gods among the gods of the three divine abodes, and the lesser nāgas."

Vajrapāṇi spoke: "Brahmin youth, listen well and hold this in mind. I shall now recite this very heart-essence, which is constantly proclaimed by all the

wrathful Sugatas.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍa-vajrapāṇaye, mahāyakṣasenāpataye. Tadyathā: Oṃ hara hara vajra, matha matha vajra, dhuna dhuna vajra, daha daha vajra, paca paca vajra, dhara dhara vajra, dhāraya dhāraya vajra, dāruṇa dāruṇa vajra, chinda chinda vajra, bhinda bhinda vajra, hūṃ phaṭ. Namaś caṇḍa-vajrakrodhāya. Hulu hulu, tiṣṭha tiṣṭha, bandha bandha, hana hana, amṛte hūṃ phaṭ.

"Brahmin youth, whoever takes a portion of the nectar of the Sugata swirling within, and recites these vajra words of all the wrathful ones, projecting from every single pore countless subtle vajras outward in the ten directions — all the evil habitual tendencies of every sentient being are purified; life and merit flourish greatly; one is liberated from enemies, poisons, and untimely death. As for any evil adversarial intent directed against such a person — one visualizes it as dispersed by a cloud of ricinus smoke, or as a fresh myrobalan fruit crushed flat beneath gold, and then recites these vajra words. By radiating the subtle vajras, the five aggregates and the five sense faculties of those adversaries are swiftly destroyed. If a god recites it, within one divine month or divine year, an asura's head will split open. If a monk recites it, the weapons of Māra are swiftly subdued. If a human recites it, the one at whom it is aimed will certainly be destroyed within one human month or five human years."

The Blessed One said "Excellent!" to Vajrapāṇi and the brahmin youth, and then vanished from sight.

Translator's Notes

- The passage about "ricinus smoke" renders the Tibetan term for the castor plant or a similar noxious plant used in ritual contexts. The simile compares the dissolution of harmful intent to smoke dispersing a cloud, and a fresh myrobalan being crushed flat as if gilded — these are standard tantric analogies for nullifying hostile forces; the rendering is interpretive but follows the grammar closely.

The phrase "Lord of Secrets" (gsang ba pa'i bdag po) is a standard epithet of Vajrapāṇi in this textual tradition and has been rendered as such throughout rather than repeated in Sanskrit.

The mantra syllables are rendered in standard romanized Sanskrit transliteration as found in the Tibetan phonetic approximation; minor phonetic variations in the Tibetan spelling are normalized to standard Sanskrit forms for clarity.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.